Funding Plan: Cash Flow, Sequence and Cost

Sample Client | Sample Logistics LLC | Florida

Prepared Oct 21, 2026 by Funding Consultant | Start Oct 21, 2026

Profile Snapshot

Measure	Value	Measure	Value
Middle credit score	701	**Funding tier**	700-749
Experian / Equifax / TransUnion	712 / 688 / 701	**Strongest / weakest report**	TransUnion / Equifax
Hard inquiries, 6 mo (EX/EQ/TU)	1 / 3 / 0	**New accounts, 24 mo**	3
Personal utilization	31%	**All cards utilization**	36%
Total card limits	$23,000	**Total card balances**	$8,200
Business entity	LLC	**NAICS**	484121 (Transportation and Warehousing)
Time in business	20 months	**Employees**	3
Annual revenue	$240,000	**Monthly deposits**	$20,000
EIN / D-U-N-S / business bank	Yes / Yes / Yes	**Paydex**	72
Banking relationships	Chase, Navy Federal	**Funding goal**	$100,000

Readiness Check

Status	Finding
Fix first	Personal utilization is 31%. Paying $2,830 to bring it under 10% before statement dates is the fastest score lift available.
Caution	Equifax has 3 hard inquiries in 6 months. Avoid lenders likely to pull Equifax until it drops under 3.
Fix first	1 late payment or collection item(s) reported. Dispute errors and bring accounts current; these weigh more than any new account.
Caution	Equifax is the weakest report and TransUnion the strongest. The sequence below favors lenders likely to pull TransUnion in Florida.

Layer 1: Cash Flow Forecast (12 Months)

Funding need $100,000, deepest shortfall in month 2. Average monthly operating cash flow $3,687; lowest cash without funding $-30,549. Need = the deepest dip below the $5,000 cash buffer, or the $100,000 funding goal if larger.

Month	Revenue	Outflows	One-Time Spend	Operating Cash Flow	Ending Cash (no funding)
1	$18,000	$16,450		$1,550	$7,550
2	$18,540	$16,639	$40,000	$1,901	$-30,549
3	$19,096	$16,834		$2,263	$-28,286
4	$19,669	$17,034		$2,635	$-25,652
5	$20,259	$17,241		$3,018	$-22,633
6	$20,867	$17,453		$3,414	$-19,220
7	$21,493	$17,673		$3,820	$-15,399
8	$22,138	$17,898		$4,240	$-11,160
9	$22,802	$18,131		$4,671	$-6,488
10	$23,486	$18,370		$5,116	$-1,373
11	$24,190	$18,617		$5,574	$4,201

Month	Revenue	Outflows	One-Time Spend	Operating Cash Flow	Ending Cash (no funding)
12	$24,916	$18,871		$6,046	$10,247

Layer 2: Bureau Plan for Florida

Across all lenders, Florida leans Experian (47%; clear lean, 882 datapoints).

#	Lender	Likely Bureau	Fit	Why
1	**Chase**	Experian 43%	Good	Likely Experian (43%) in Florida. Close call; another bureau is possible. 5/24 rule: denied with 5+ new personal accounts in 24 months. One business card per 30 days.
2	**American Express**	Experian 88%	Good	Likely Experian (88%) in Florida. Up to 2 cards per 90 days. Existing customers are often approved on a soft pull.
3	**Bank of America**	Experian 61%	Good	Likely Experian (61%) in Florida. Experian for personal; relationship banking helps limits.
4	**Barclays**	TransUnion 68%	Good	Likely TransUnion (68%) in Florida. Matches the strongest report.
5	**Elan**	TransUnion 49%	Good	Likely TransUnion (49%) in Florida. Matches the strongest report. Close call; another bureau is possible.
6	**U.S. Bank**	Equifax 50%	Caution	Likely Equifax (50%) in Florida. That is the weakest report; apply later or after it improves. Sensitive to 5+ new accounts in 12 months. Banking relationship helps.
7	**Wells Fargo**	Equifax 42%	Caution	Likely Equifax (42%) in Florida. That is the weakest report; apply later or after it improves. Possible double pull if new to the bank.
8	**Citi**	Equifax 48%	Caution	Likely Equifax (48%) in Florida. That is the weakest report; apply later or after it improves.
9	**Capital One**	Equifax 44%	Caution	Likely Equifax (44%) in Florida. That is the weakest report; apply later or after it improves. Pulls all three bureaus; most business cards report to personal credit. Apply last.

Layer 2: Funding Sequence and Benchmark Timeline

Date	Phase	Action	Bureau	Typical Amount
Oct 21, 2026	Prepare	Pull all three credit reports and dispute any errors annualcreditreport.com. Note which bureau is cleanest.	None	
Oct 21, 2026	Prepare	Pay personal card balances down by $2,830 Pay before each statement closes so the lower balance reports.	None	
Oct 21, 2026	Prepare	Open business checking at U.S. Bank 30 days before applying A deposit relationship improves approval odds and limits.	None	
Oct 28, 2026	Prepare	Bring past-due accounts current; dispute inaccurate late payments and collections Ask for goodwill adjustments on one-time lates.	None	
Oct 28, 2026	Business Setup	Open 3 net-30 vendor account(s) that report to business bureaus Uline, Quill, Grainger, Crown Office Supplies.	No personal pull	$500 to $2,000 per vendor
Dec 20, 2026	Round 1	Apply: Chase 5/24 rule: denied with 5+ new personal accounts in 24 months. One business card per 30 days. Likely Experian (43%) in Florida. Close call; another bureau is possible.	Experian (43%)	$5,000 to $25,000 each
Dec 20, 2026	Business Funding	Online business line of credit (soft pull to see offers) Fundbox about 600, Bluevine and OnDeck about 625; bank statements, no hard pull to quote.	No hard pull to quote	$5,000 to $100,000
Jan 3, 2027	Round 2	Apply: American Express Up to 2 cards per 90 days. Existing customers are often approved on a soft pull. Likely Experian (88%) in Florida.	Experian (88%)	$5,000 to $25,000 each

Date	Phase	Action	Bureau	Typical Amount
Jan 17, 2027	Round 3	Apply: Bank of America Experian for personal; relationship banking helps limits. Likely Experian (61%) in Florida.	Experian (61%)	$5,000 to $20,000 each
Jan 31, 2027	Round 4	Apply: Barclays Likely TransUnion (68%) in Florida. Matches the strongest report.	TransUnion (68%)	
Feb 14, 2027	Round 5	Apply: Elan Likely TransUnion (49%) in Florida. Matches the strongest report. Close call; another bureau is possible.	TransUnion (49%)	$5,000 to $30,000 each
Feb 18, 2027	Business Funding	Bank line of credit or SBA 7(a) once 2 years in business Two years of returns and steady revenue open the lowest-cost capital.	Lender's choice	Up to $5M (SBA)
Apr 19, 2027	Later	Optional: U.S. Bank Sensitive to 5+ new accounts in 12 months. Banking relationship helps. Likely Equifax (50%) in Florida. That is the weakest report; apply later or after it improves.	Equifax (50%)	$5,000 to $20,000 each
Apr 29, 2027	Grow	Request credit limit increases, then cool off 60 to 90 days Amex reviews on a soft pull; Chase uses a hard pull.	Amex soft; Chase hard	+50% to +200%
May 3, 2027	Later	Optional: Wells Fargo Possible double pull if new to the bank. Likely Equifax (42%) in Florida. That is the weakest report; apply later or after it improves.	Equifax (42%)	$5,000 to $150,000
May 17, 2027	Later	Optional: Citi Likely Equifax (48%) in Florida. That is the weakest report; apply later or after it improves.	Equifax (48%)	$5,000 to $30,000 each
May 31, 2027	Later	Optional: Capital One Pulls all three bureaus; most business cards report to personal credit. Apply last. Likely Equifax (44%) in Florida. That is the weakest report; apply later or after it improves.	Equifax (44%)	

Planning range for the card rounds: $20,000 to $100,000 in initial limits, before limit increases.

Benchmarks

Target Date	Benchmark	How
Nov 25, 2026	**Personal utilization under 10%**	Total personal balances at or below $1,170.
Feb 14, 2027	**Core business card rounds complete**	No more than one hard pull per bureau per round, 7 to 14 days apart.
Feb 18, 2027	**Paydex score of 80 (pays on time)**	Pay every vendor on or before the due date; paying early lifts it above 80.
Feb 18, 2027	**2 years in business**	Opens bank lines, SBA 7(a) and larger term loans.
Apr 19, 2027	**Under 3 hard inquiries per bureau in the past 6 months**	Inquiries count in scoring for 12 months and stay on the report for 24.
Jun 18, 2027	**Middle score reaches 750 (750-799 tier)**	49 points from 701. On-time payments, utilization under 10% and no new hard pulls outside the plan.

Target dates are planning estimates from the inputs, not guarantees. Recheck scores monthly and move dates as results come in.

Layer 3: Cost and Repayment Model

$100,000 funded in month 2; 12 months at 0% on the card rounds, then 24% APR amortized over 36 months. Peak monthly payment $3,079; interest in the first 24 months $15,696; balance after 24 months $63,378. Debt service coverage 1.16x (lenders usually want 1.25x or better).

Month	3	6	9	12	15	18	21	24
Payment	$1,960	$1,845	$1,736	$1,634	$3,019	$2,849	$2,687	$2,535
Balance	$96,040	$90,392	$85,076	$80,073	$75,482	$71,210	$67,180	$63,378

Scenarios: Does the Plan Still Work?

Case	Funding Need	Peak Payment	Avg Operating CF	Coverage	Months to Cash-Out	Verdict
Base	$100,000	$3,079	$3,687	1.16x	2	**Tight**
Downside: revenue -20%, promo ends month 13	$100,000	$3,079	$920	0.42x	2	**Fails**
Upside: revenue +15%	$100,000	$3,079	$5,763	1.72x	2	**Works**

Works: coverage at or above 1.25x. Tight: 1.0x to 1.25x. Fails: the business cannot carry the payments after the promo ends; fund less, extend the term or raise revenue first.

Business Credit Plan

Report	Entered	Next Step
Dun & Bradstreet Paydex	72	Below 80: pay every vendor on or before the due date.
Experian Intelliscore Plus	N/A	Add vendors that report to Experian Business.
Equifax Business	N/A	Builds from bank and card trade lines that report to Equifax.
Creditsafe	N/A	Builds from public filings and trade data once the entity is active.
Trade lines reporting	2	Target 5 reporting vendors: Uline, Quill, Grainger, Crown Office Supplies.

Funding Entities That Fit This Business

NAICS 484121: Transportation and Warehousing. 20 months in business. Revenue $240,000 a year.

Fintech & Corporate: Corporate cards that underwrite on cash balances, not personal credit.

Lender	Bureau	Minimum	Documentation
Brex (acquired by Capital One, April 2026)	No hard pull	No personal credit check	Yes
Ramp	No hard pull	No personal credit check	Yes
BILL Divvy Corporate Card	Not documented	Soft pull to start (community reports)	Partial
Capital on Tap Business Credit Card (WebBank)	Not documented	About 670 (community estimate)	Partial

Invoice Factoring: Advances against unpaid invoices; approval leans on your customers' credit.

Lender	Bureau	Minimum	Documentation
altLINE (The Southern Bank Company)	No hard pull	None	Yes
FundThrough	No hard pull	None published	Yes
Riviera Finance	No hard pull	None published	Yes
Other factors (RTS Financial, eCapital, Universal Funding, Scale Funding)	No hard pull	None published	Yes

Equipment Financing: The equipment secures the loan, so score floors are lower.

Lender	Bureau	Minimum	Documentation
Taycor Financial	No hard pull	550	Yes
Creditfy	Not documented	550	Partial
Triton Capital	Not documented	660 personal	Partial
SMB Compass	Not documented	680	Partial

Online Business Lenders: Lines and term loans based on bank deposits.

Lender	Bureau	Minimum	Documentation
Fundbox	No hard pull	600	Yes
OnDeck	No hard pull	625	Yes
Bluevine	No hard pull	625	Yes
Headway Capital	No hard pull	About 625 (estimate)	Yes

SBA, CDFI: Lowest-cost capital; microloans fit startups and thinner files.

Lender	Bureau	Minimum	Documentation
SBA 7(a) loans (through banks and SBLCs)	Varies	No SBA minimum since March 1, 2026; lenders set their own (often 650+)	No
SBA Express and CAPLines	Varies	650 for CAPLines per NerdWallet	No
SBA Microloan (through nonprofit intermediaries)	Not documented	Generally 620	Partial
SBA Office of Disaster Assistance (EIDL and disaster loans)	Varies	n/a	No

Vendor / Net-30: Builds the business credit file with no personal pull.

Lender	Bureau	Minimum	Documentation
Uline	No hard pull	No personal pull	Yes
Quill	No hard pull	No personal pull	Yes
Grainger	No hard pull	No personal pull	Yes
Crown Office Supplies	No hard pull	No personal pull	Yes

Rules Behind the Plan

Read your own reports first. Pull all three reports at annualcreditreport.com and note which bureau is cleanest. Use the Lender Database tab to pick lenders that pull that bureau in your state.

Spread inquiries across bureaus. Experian-leaning: Chase, Amex, Wells Fargo, Bank of America, FNBO, PNC, M&T, TD, USAA. TransUnion-leaning: U.S. Bank, Barclays, Synchrony, Navy Federal, Elan, Apple Card. Equifax-leaning: Truist, Citizens, PenFed, DCU, Huntington, KeyBank, Target (TD). All three: Capital One. Applying to one lender from each group keeps any single report from stacking up.

Order by strictest rule first. Chase goes first because of 5/24. Then Amex (2 cards per 90 days), then U.S. Bank (dislikes 5+ new accounts in 12 months), then Wells Fargo, then Bank of America, then regionals. Capital One goes last because it hits all three bureaus and most of its business cards report to personal credit.

Soft pulls before hard pulls. Use prequalification tools (Capital One, Discover, Amex Apply With Confidence, Upstart, Upgrade, Fundbox, Capital on Tap) to see offers before taking a hard inquiry.

Business credit runs in parallel at every tier. Form the entity, get an EIN and D-U-N-S number, open a business checking account, then add 3 to 5 net-30 vendors. None of this touches personal credit and it supports every later application.

Stated income is still a statement under penalty of law. Low-doc and no-doc mean the lender does not collect tax returns up front. Income and revenue figures must be accurate, and lenders can ask for proof later (Amex financial reviews are the best known example).

These are patterns, not guarantees. Minimum scores are published floors or community estimates. Income, debt-to-income, utilization, account age, recent inquiries and deposits decide the outcome as much as the score.

Sources and Limits

Bureau likelihoods come from a logistic regression on consumer-reported inquiry datapoints (2008 to 2026) across 49 states and 56 cited sources, as of October 7, 2026. No lender publishes which bureau it pulls by state. Minimum scores are published floors or community estimates. Income, debt-to-income, utilization, account age, recent inquiries and deposits decide outcomes as much as the score. This is a planning reference, not financial, credit or legal advice.

Full data, methods and sources: shamarrobinson.github.io/client-personal-and-business-funding-sequence-dashboard